

DS 542 - Spring 2026 - Homework 1

Feel free to write your answers by hand. No need for LaTeX; just make sure it is legible.

1. Equation 2.5 in the textbook (Understanding Deep Learning) gives the equation for linear regression with one input variable using the least-squares loss.

$$\begin{aligned} L[\phi] &= \sum_{i=1}^I (f[x_i, \phi] - y_i)^2 \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^I (\phi_0 + \phi_1 x_i - y_i)^2 \end{aligned}$$

- (a) **(2 points)** Derive the formula for $\partial L / \partial \phi_0$.

$$\frac{\partial L}{\partial \phi_0} = 2 \sum_{i=1}^I (\phi_0 + \phi_1 x_i - y_i) \quad \text{X}$$

- (b) **(2 points)** Derive the formula for $\partial L / \partial \phi_1$.

$$\frac{\partial L}{\partial \phi_1} = 2 \sum_{i=1}^I x_i (\phi_0 + \phi_1 x_i - y_i) \quad \text{X}$$

2. Answer the following questions about the following equation.

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 4 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 8 & 7 \\ 5 & 6 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} x_{0,0} & x_{0,1} \\ x_{1,0} & x_{1,1} \end{bmatrix}$$

- (a) **(2 points)** What is the mathematical operation on the lefthand side of the equation?

matrix multiplication ✖

- (b) **(2 points)** Write out the formula to calculate $x_{1,0}$.

$$x_{1,0} = 4 \times 8 + 3 \times 5 = 47 \quad \text{✖}$$

3. **(2 points)** Answer the following questions about ordinary least squares linear regression, where y_i is the target value and $\hat{y}_i$ is the predicted value. What is the equation for the mean residual on the training data?

$$\text{residual} = y_i - \hat{y}_i \Rightarrow \text{mean residual} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n (y_i - \hat{y}_i) \quad \text{✖}$$

4. Answer the following questions about basic probability.

- (a) **(2 points)** Suppose A and B are events with $P(A) = 0.4$, $P(B) = 0.5$, and $P(A \cap B) = 0.2$. Compute $P(A | B)$ and $P(A \cup B)$.

$$P(A|B) = \frac{P(A \cap B)}{P(B)} = \frac{0.2}{0.5} = 0.4 \quad \text{✖} \quad P(A \cup B) = P(A) + P(B) - P(A \cap B) = 0.4 + 0.5 - 0.2 = 0.7 \quad \text{✖}$$

- (b) **(2 points)** Let X be a Bernoulli random variable with $P(X = 1) = p$. What are $\mathbb{E}[X]$ and $\text{Var}(X)$?

$$P(X=1)=p \Rightarrow P(X=0)=1-p \quad \mathbb{E}(X) = 1 \cdot p + 0 \cdot (1-p) = p \quad \text{✖}$$

$$\text{Var}(X) = \mathbb{E}(X^2) - \mathbb{E}(X)^2 = 1^2 \cdot p + 0^2 \cdot (1-p) - p^2 = p(1-p) \quad \text{✖}$$